8 Open the text file

This next bit of code will open the file called events.txt so the program can read it. Type in this line underneath your code from Step 7.

```
def get_events():
    list_events = []
    with open('events.txt') as file:
```

This line opens the text file.

9 Start a loop

Now add a **for** loop to bring information from the text file into your program. The loop will be run for every line in the events.txt file.

```
def get_events():
    list_events = []
    with open('events.txt') as file:
        for line in file:
```

Run the loop for each line in the text file.

10 Remove the invisible character

When you typed information into the text file in Step 1, you pressed the enter/return key at the end of each line. This added an invisible "newline" character at the end of every line. Although you can't see this character, Python can. Add this line of code, which tells Python to ignore these invisible characters when it reads the text file.

```
    with open('events.txt') as file:
        for line in file:
            line = line.rstrip('\n')
```

Remove the newline character from each line.

The newline character is represented as **('\n')** in Python.

11 Store the event details

At this point, the variable called **line** holds the information about each event as a string, such as **Halloween,31/10/2017**. Use the **split()** command to chop this string into two parts. The parts before and after the comma will become separate items that you can store in a list called **current_event**. Add this line after your code in Step 10.

```
        for line in file:
            line = line.rstrip('\n')
            current_event = line.split(',')
```

Split each event into two parts at the comma.

EXPERT TIPS

Datetime module

Python's **datetime** module is very useful if you want to do calculations involving dates and time. For example, do you know what day of the week you were born on? Try typing this into the Python shell to find out.

Type your birthday in this format: year, month, day.

```
>>> from datetime import *
>>> print(date(2007, 12, 4).weekday())
1
```

This number represents the day of the week, where Monday is 0 and Sunday is 6. So 4 December 2007 was a Tuesday.